

Sumcheck-free hypercube inner products from table-form Kronecker encodings

Research note (companion to Kronecker-FRI)

September 2026 — version 3 (Section 3 proved; Rust prototypes of Sections 2 and 3)

Abstract

We encode a multilinear polynomial by its *table*, $V_f(X) = \sum_w f(w)X^w$, instead of its coefficients. Two quantities then become single coefficients of univariate products: the evaluation $\tilde{f}(z)$, with a product-form kernel, and the hypercube inner product $\sum_w a(w)b(w)$ of two committed tables, through the reversal $V_b^*(X) = X^{N-1}V_b(1/X)$. Because a smooth domain is closed under inversion, the verifier reads V_b^* from the commitment to b as a virtual word, and the Kronecker-FRI machinery (opening polynomial, virtual word, one folding test) proves $\sum_w a(w)b(w) = S$ with no sumcheck, with soundness error $3M/|\mathbb{F}| + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa$. With geometric weights γ^w and DEEP quotients as further virtual words, the same method gives a sumcheck-free Hadamard check $a \circ b = c$ for three committed tables, with soundness error $(N - 1)/(|\mathbb{F}| - M - 1) + (N - 1)/(|\mathbb{F}| - 2M) + 8M/|\mathbb{F}| + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa$.

Setting. Notation and parameters are those of Kronecker-FRI (KF) [1]: $n \geq 1$, $N = 2^n$, a smooth domain $L \leq \mathbb{F}^\times$ of order $M = 2^{n+R}$ with $R \geq 2$, codes $\mathcal{C}_j$, the folding test $\Pi_{\text{FT}}[\ell, \kappa]$ with error $\varepsilon_{\text{fold}}$ (KF Thm 5.24), fibre distance Δ_0^{fib} , and $0 < \delta \leq \delta^* = (1 - \rho)/2$. A bit vector $w \in \{0, 1\}^n$ is identified with the integer $\sum_k w_k 2^{k-1} \in [0, N - 1]$.

1 Table encoding and two extraction identities

Definition 1 (Table encoding, reversal). For a table $f : \{0, 1\}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{F}$, $V_f(X) = \sum_w f(w)X^w \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and $\text{Enc}^T(f) = \text{ev}_L(V_f)$. For $P \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$, its reversal is $P^*(X) = X^{N-1}P(1/X)$, so $[X^j]P^* = [X^{N-1-j}]P$ and $(P^*)^* = P$.

$f \mapsto V_f$ is a linear bijection onto $\mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$, so Enc^T is a linear bijection onto $\mathcal{C}_0$ (as KF Lemma 6.3(1)); it is the Kronecker encoding of the multilinear polynomial whose coefficients are the values of f , and needs no Möbius transform. In particular $\text{Enc}^T(f) = \text{Enc}(f)$ as maps on vectors of length N : a table-form commitment is an ordinary Kronecker-FRI commitment to the vector of values, with the same Merkle tree, and all of KF's results on commitments (unique decoding, extraction, batching) apply to it unchanged.

Lemma 2 (Evaluation). For $z \in \mathbb{F}^n$ let $E_z^*(X) = \prod_{k=1}^n (z_k + (1 - z_k)X^{2^{k-1}})$. Then $\tilde{f}(z) = [X^{N-1}]V_f E_z^*$, where $\tilde{f}$ is the multilinear extension of f .

Proof. Expanding the product, $E_z(X) := \sum_w \text{eq}(w, z)X^w = \prod_k ((1 - z_k) + z_k X^{2^{k-1}})$, and $X^{N-1}E_z(1/X) = \prod_k X^{2^{k-1}}((1 - z_k) + z_k X^{-2^{k-1}}) = E_z^*(X)$ since $N - 1 = \sum_k 2^{k-1}$. Hence $[X^{N-1-w}]E_z^* = [X^w]E_z = \text{eq}(w, z)$ and $[X^{N-1}]V_f E_z^* = \sum_w f(w) \text{eq}(w, z) = \tilde{f}(z)$. $\square$

Lemma 3 (Inner product). For tables a, b : $\sum_w a(w)b(w) = [X^{N-1}]V_a V_b^*$.

Proof. $[X^{N-1}] V_a V_b^* = \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} [X^i] V_a [X^{N-1-i}] V_b^* = \sum_i [X^i] V_a [X^i] V_b = \sum_w a(w)b(w)$. $\square$

Both are instances of one fact: for $U \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and a public $K \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$, $[X^{N-1}] UK = \sum_i [X^i] U [X^{N-1-i}] K$. KF's split lemma (Lemma 4.10) and identity lemma (Lemma 4.12) use only $\deg U, \deg K \leq N-1$, so they hold verbatim for UK replaced by $V_a E_z^*$ or $V_a V_b^*$:

Lemma 4 (Split and identity, general form). *Let $U, K, A, H \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and $v \in \mathbb{F}$. (1) There are $A, H \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ with $XUK = A + vX^N + X^{N+1}H$ iff $v = [X^{N-1}] UK$. (2) $\Phi = XUK - A - vX^N - X^{N+1}H$ has degree at most $2N$, and $\Phi = 0$ implies $v = [X^{N-1}] UK$.*

Proof. As in KF Lemmas 4.10 and 4.12: $\deg(UK) \leq 2N-2$, and the three parts of the right-hand side occupy the disjoint degree ranges $[0, N-1]$, $\{N\}$, $[N+1, 2N]$; compare the coefficients of X^N . $\square$

Lemma 5 (Reversed words). *For $w \in \mathbb{F}^L$ put $w^*(\xi) = \xi^{N-1}w(\xi^{-1})$. Then: (1) $w = \text{ev}_L(P)$ with $P \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ implies $w^* = \text{ev}_L(P^*)$; in particular $w \mapsto w^*$ maps $\mathcal{C}_0$ onto $\mathcal{C}_0$; (2) $w \mapsto w^*$ is a linear bijection of $\mathbb{F}^L$, and $w^* = c^*$ at ξ iff $w = c$ at ξ^{-1} ; (3) a set $T \subseteq L$ is fibre-closed iff $T^{-1} = \{\xi^{-1} : \xi \in T\}$ is, and $|T^{-1}| = |T|$; (4) $h(\xi) = w^*(\xi)$ is computed from the value of w at $\xi^{-1} \in L$, and a fold check at $\pm\xi$ reads w on the fibre $\{\pm\xi^{-1}\}$.*

Proof. L is a group, so $\xi \mapsto \xi^{-1}$ is a bijection of L mapping $-\xi$ to $-\xi^{-1}$ (as $-1 \in L$); and $\xi^{N-1} \neq 0$. (1) $\xi^{N-1}P(\xi^{-1}) = P^*(\xi)$, and $P \mapsto P^*$ is a bijection of $\mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$. (2)–(4) follow from the first sentence. $\square$

2 The inner-product protocol

Definition 6 (Π_{IP}). Instance: oracles $w_a, w_b \in \mathbb{F}^L$ and $S \in \mathbb{F}$; honestly $w_a = \text{Enc}^T(a)$, $w_b = \text{Enc}^T(b)$ and $S = \sum_w a(w)b(w)$.

1. The prover sends $w_A = \text{ev}_L(A)$, where $XV_a V_b^* = A + SX^N + X^{N+1}H$ (Lemma 4); the verifier sends $\beta \in \mathbb{F}$.
2. Put the virtual words w_b^* (Lemma 5) and $h(\xi) = (\xi w_a(\xi) w_b^*(\xi) - w_A(\xi) - S\xi^N)/\xi^{N+1}$, and

$$w_0 = w_a + \beta w_b^* + \beta^2 w_A + \beta^3 h.$$

3. Run $\Pi_{\text{FT}}[\ell, \kappa]$ (or Π_{FT}^C , KF Prop. 5.28) on w_0 .

Per query point the verifier reads $w_a(\pm\xi)$, $w_b(\pm\xi^{-1})$ and $w_A(\pm\xi)$, and does $O(1)$ extra field operations beyond KF (no kernel to evaluate).

Theorem 7 (Completeness). *If $w_a = \text{ev}_L(V_a)$, $w_b = \text{ev}_L(V_b)$ and $S = \sum_w a(w)b(w)$, the honest prover is accepted with probability 1.*

Proof. By Lemma 3 and Lemma 4(1), $A, H \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ exist; by Lemma 5(1) $w_b^* = \text{ev}_L(V_b^*)$; evaluating the identity at ξ gives $h = \text{ev}_L(H)$. So $w_0 = \text{ev}_L(V_a + \beta V_b^* + \beta^2 A + \beta^3 H)$ with a polynomial of degree $< N$, and KF Lemma 5.9(1) applies. $\square$

Definition 8 (Relation). $\mathcal{R}_{\text{IP}}^\delta$: $((w_a, w_b; S), (a, b))$ with $\Delta_0^{\text{fib}}(w_a, \text{Enc}^T(a)) \leq \delta$, $\Delta_0^{\text{fib}}(w_b, \text{Enc}^T(b)) \leq \delta$ and $\sum_w a(w)b(w) = S$.

Lemma 9 (Batching, degree 3). *Let $\mathcal{G}$ be the set of β for which w_0 agrees with some $c \in \mathcal{C}_0$ on a fibre-closed $T \subseteq L$ with $|T| \geq (1 - \delta)M$. If $|\mathcal{G}| > 3M$, then $(w_a, w_b; S)$ has a witness in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{IP}}^\delta$.*

Proof. The words w_0 form the curve of degree 3 generated by (w_a, w_b^*, w_A, h) , and every $\beta \in \mathcal{G}$ has $\Delta(w_0, \mathcal{C}_0) \leq \delta$. By correlated agreement for curves (KF Thm 2.16, from [2], with $t = 3$) there are $P_0, P_1, P_2, P_3 \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and a set Agr, $|\text{Agr}| \geq (1 - \delta)M$, on which $w_a = \text{ev}(P_0)$, $w_b^* = \text{ev}(P_1)$, $w_A = \text{ev}(P_2)$, $h = \text{ev}(P_3)$ (take Agr maximal).

Value. Let $\Phi = XP_0P_1 - P_2 - SX^N - X^{N+1}P_3$. On Agr, $\Phi(\xi) = \xi w_a(\xi)w_b^*(\xi) - w_A(\xi) - S\xi^N - \xi^{N+1}h(\xi) = 0$ by the definition of h . Since $\deg \Phi \leq 2N < (1 - \delta)M \leq |\text{Agr}|$ (KF Lemma 7.2, which uses $R \geq 2$), $\Phi = 0$, and Lemma 4(2) gives $S = [X^{N-1}]P_0P_1$. Let a, b be the tables with $V_a = P_0$ and $V_b = P_1^*$; then $V_b^* = P_1$ and $S = \sum_w a(w)b(w)$ by Lemma 3.

Bad challenges. For $\xi \notin \text{Agr}$, $d_\xi(Z) = \sum_{i=0}^3 Z^i(u_i - \text{ev}(P_i))(\xi)$, with $(u_0, \dots, u_3) = (w_a, w_b^*, w_A, h)$, is a nonzero polynomial of degree ≤ 3 ; its roots over all such ξ form a set Bad with $|\text{Bad}| \leq 3\delta M < 3M < |\mathcal{G}|$. Take $\beta \in \mathcal{G} \setminus \text{Bad}$ with its c and T , and $\hat{c} = \sum_i \beta^i \text{ev}(P_i) \in \mathcal{C}_0$. Then c and $\hat{c}$ agree with w_0 on $T \cap \text{Agr}$, of size $\geq (1 - 2\delta)M \geq N$, so $c = \hat{c}$; and for $\xi \in T$, $d_\xi(\beta) = w_0(\xi) - \hat{c}(\xi) = 0$ forces $\xi \in \text{Agr}$. So $T \subseteq \text{Agr}$.

Distances. $w_a = \text{ev}(V_a)$ on the fibre-closed T , so $\Delta_0^{\text{fb}}(w_a, \text{Enc}^T(a)) \leq \delta$ (KF Lemma 5.11(2)). $w_b^* = \text{ev}(V_b^*) = \text{ev}(V_b)^*$ on T , so by Lemma 5(2) $w_b = \text{ev}(V_b)$ on T^{-1} , which is fibre-closed of the same size (Lemma 5(3)); so $\Delta_0^{\text{fb}}(w_b, \text{Enc}^T(b)) \leq \delta$. $\square$

Theorem 10 (Soundness). *If $(w_a, w_b; S)$ has no witness in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{IP}}^\delta$, every prover is accepted with probability at most*

$$\frac{3M}{|\mathbb{F}|} + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa < \frac{4M}{|\mathbb{F}|} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa.$$

Proof. Identical to KF Thm 7.8, with Lemma 9 in place of KF Lemma 7.4: for $\beta \notin \mathcal{G}$ (probability $\geq 1 - 3M/|\mathbb{F}|$) and good r (probability $\geq 1 - \varepsilon_{\text{fold}}$, KF Thm 5.24(1)), the codeword chain (KF Prop. 5.23) shows that $\text{dens}_\ell(w_\ell) \geq 1 - \delta$ would put β in $\mathcal{G}$, the witness set $\mathcal{W}_\ell(w_\ell)$ being fibre-closed (KF Lemma 7.7); so the query term is at most $(1 - \delta)^\kappa$ (KF Lemma 3.3). $\square$

Round-by-round knowledge soundness, the extractor (decode w_a and w_b at radius δ^*) and binding follow as in KF Thm 7.11 and Cor. 7.12, with round-1 error $3M/|\mathbb{F}|$.

Remark 11 (One commitment, three kinds of openings). The same table-form commitment $\text{Enc}^T(f)$ supports: evaluation openings at any z (KF's protocol with the kernel E_z^* of Lemma 2, evaluated by the verifier with $O(n)$ operations); hypercube sums ($z = (\frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2})$ up to 2^n , or the kernel $\prod_k (1 + X^{2^{k-1}})$ directly); and inner products with any other committed table (Π_{IP}). Inner products with a *public* table p are the special case $K = V_p^*$, useful when $V_p^*(\xi)$ is cheap to evaluate (product form). All of these batch with KF's batched openings (KF Thm 11.2).

3 A sumcheck-free Hadamard check

SNARKs of Spartan/HyperPlonk type need, beyond linear functionals and inner products, the statement $a(w)b(w) = c(w)$ for all w (a *Hadamard check*), for three committed tables.

Geometric weights. For $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}$,

$$\sum_w \gamma^w a(w)b(w) = [X^{N-1}] V_a(\gamma X) V_b^*(X), \quad \sum_w \gamma^w c(w) = V_c(\gamma),$$

the first by Lemma 3 applied to the tables $w \mapsto \gamma^w a(w)$ and b . If $d = a \circ b - c \neq 0$, then $D_d(X) = \sum_w d(w)X^w$ is a nonzero polynomial of degree $\leq N - 1$, and the two sides differ unless $D_d(\gamma) = 0$. The values $V_a(\gamma\xi)$ and $V_c(\gamma)$ lie outside L ; the prover commits to $Q(X) = V_a(\gamma X)$, and both are tied to the commitments by DEEP quotients, which are virtual words like h .

Definition 12 (Quotient words). For $w \in \mathbb{F}^L$, $y \in \mathbb{F}$ and $x \in \mathbb{F} \setminus L$, put $q[w, y, x](\xi) = (w(\xi) - y)/(\xi - x)$.

Lemma 13 (DEEP step on an agreement set). *Let $x \in \mathbb{F} \setminus L$, $y \in \mathbb{F}$, $P, R \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and $T \subseteq L$ with $|T| > N$. If $w = \text{ev}(P)$ and $q[w, y, x] = \text{ev}(R)$ on T , then $P(x) = y$ and $R = (P - y)/(X - x)$. Conversely, if $w = \text{ev}_L(P)$ and $P(x) = y$, then $q[w, y, x] = \text{ev}_L((P - y)/(X - x))$, a polynomial of degree $\leq N - 2$.*

Proof. $(X - x)R - P + y$ has degree $\leq N$ and vanishes on T , so it is 0; evaluate at x . The converse is the factor theorem. $\square$

Definition 14 (Π_{Had}). Instance: oracles $w_a, w_b, w_c \in \mathbb{F}^L$; honestly $w_f = \text{Enc}^T(f)$ for $f \in \{a, b, c\}$ and $a \circ b = c$.

1. The verifier sends γ , uniform in $\mathbb{F}^\times \setminus L$. The prover sends $w_Q = \text{ev}_L(Q)$, where $Q(X) = V_a(\gamma X)$.
2. The verifier sends θ , uniform in $\mathbb{F} \setminus (L \cup \gamma^{-1}L)$. The prover sends $y_1 = V_a(\gamma\theta)$, $y_3 = V_c(\gamma)$ and $w_A = \text{ev}_L(A)$, where $XQV_b^* = A + y_3X^N + X^{N+1}H$ (Lemma 4).
3. The verifier sends β , uniform in $\mathbb{F}$. With $h(\xi) = (\xi w_Q(\xi) w_b^*(\xi) - w_A(\xi) - y_3\xi^N)/\xi^{N+1}$ and

$$(u_0, \dots, u_8) = (w_a, w_c, w_Q, w_b^*, w_A, h, q[w_a, y_1, \gamma\theta], q[w_Q, y_1, \theta], q[w_c, y_3, \gamma]),$$

$$\text{put } w_0 = \sum_{i=0}^8 \beta^i u_i.$$

4. Run $\Pi_{\text{FT}}[\ell, \kappa]$ (or Π_{FT}^C) on w_0 .

Since $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}^\times \setminus L$ and L is a group, $L \cap \gamma^{-1}L = \emptyset$, so θ ranges over $|\mathbb{F}| - 2M$ values, and the three poles $\gamma\theta, \theta, \gamma$ lie outside L . Using y_1 for both $V_a(\gamma\theta)$ and $Q(\theta)$ is the consistency check $V_a(\gamma\theta) = Q(\theta)$. Per query point the verifier reads w_a, w_c, w_Q, w_A on the coset of ξ and w_b on the coset of ξ^{-1} , and does $O(1)$ field operations and three inversions per point (one batched inversion per query) beyond the folding test.

Theorem 15 (Completeness). *If $w_f = \text{Enc}^T(f)$ for $f \in \{a, b, c\}$ and $a \circ b = c$, the honest prover is accepted with probability 1.*

Proof. $Q \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$; $y_1 = V_a(\gamma\theta) = Q(\theta)$; and $y_3 = V_c(\gamma) = \sum_w \gamma^w c(w) = \sum_w \gamma^w a(w)b(w) = [X^{N-1}]QV_b^*$, so A, H exist and $h = \text{ev}_L(H)$ as in Π_{IP} . By Lemma 13 the three quotient words are codewords, and w_0 is the codeword of a polynomial of degree $< N$. $\square$

Definition 16 (Relation). $\mathcal{R}_{\text{Had}}^\delta$: $((w_a, w_b, w_c), (a, b, c))$ with $\Delta_0^{\text{fib}}(w_f, \text{Enc}^T(f)) \leq \delta$ for $f \in \{a, b, c\}$ and $a \circ b = c$.

Lemma 17 (Batching, degree 8). *Fix γ, θ as in Definition 14 and the prover's w_Q, y_1, y_3, w_A . Let $\mathcal{G}$ be the set of β for which w_0 agrees with some $c' \in \mathcal{C}_0$ on a fibre-closed $T \subseteq L$ with $|T| \geq (1 - \delta)M$. If $|\mathcal{G}| > 8M$, there are tables a, b, c and $\hat{Q} \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ with*

1. $\Delta_0^{\text{fib}}(w_f, \text{Enc}^T(f)) \leq \delta$ for $f \in \{a, b, c\}$, and $\Delta_0^{\text{fib}}(w_Q, \text{ev}_L(\hat{Q})) \leq \delta$;
2. $V_a(\gamma\theta) = y_1 = \hat{Q}(\theta)$;
3. $V_c(\gamma) = y_3 = [X^{N-1}] \hat{Q} V_b^*$.

Proof. Correlated agreement on one fibre-closed set (the step shared with Lemma 9; Lean: `curve_agreement`, $t = 8$) gives $P_0, \dots, P_8 \in \mathbb{F}[X]_{<N}$ and a fibre-closed T , $|T| \geq (1 - \delta)M > 2N$ (KF Lemma 7.2), with $u_i = \text{ev}(P_i)$ on T . As in Lemma 9, $XP_2P_3 - P_4 - y_3X^N - X^{N+1}P_5$ vanishes on T and has degree $\leq 2N$, so $y_3 = [X^{N-1}]P_2P_3$. Lemma 13 with $(P_0, P_6, \gamma\theta)$, (P_2, P_7, θ) and (P_1, P_8, γ) gives $P_0(\gamma\theta) = y_1$, $P_2(\theta) = y_1$ and $P_1(\gamma) = y_3$. Let $V_a = P_0$, $V_c = P_1$, $V_b = P_3^*$ and $\hat{Q} = P_2$; then (2) and (3) hold, and (1) follows from agreement on T (for w_b , on T^{-1} , Lemma 5). $\square$

Theorem 18 (Soundness). *Let $R \geq 2$ and $0 < \delta \leq \delta^*$. If (w_a, w_b, w_c) has no witness in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{Had}}^\delta$, every prover is accepted with probability at most*

$$\varepsilon_{\text{Had}} = \frac{N-1}{|\mathbb{F}| - M - 1} + \frac{N-1}{|\mathbb{F}| - 2M} + \frac{8M}{|\mathbb{F}|} + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa.$$

Proof. For $\delta \leq \delta^*$ each word has at most one codeword within fibre distance δ (KF Lemma 6.3(2)), so the tables and $\hat{Q}$ of Lemma 17 are the decodings of w_a, w_b, w_c, w_Q . It suffices to consider deterministic provers (a randomised prover is an average of deterministic ones), so w_Q is a function of γ and the round-2 messages are functions of (γ, θ) . Call (γ, θ) *good* if, for every choice of the prover's round-2 messages, $|\mathcal{G}| \leq 8M$. For good (γ, θ) the argument of KF Thm 7.8 applied to the rest of the protocol bounds the acceptance probability by $8M/|\mathbb{F}| + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa$. It remains to bound the probability that (γ, θ) is not good.

Case 1: some w_f has no table within fibre distance δ . Lemma 17(1) fails, so every (γ, θ) is good.

Case 2: w_a, w_b, w_c decode to $\hat{a}, \hat{b}, \hat{c}$ with $\hat{a} \circ \hat{b} \neq \hat{c}$. Let $D = D_{\hat{a} \circ \hat{b} - \hat{c}} \neq 0$. The event $D(\gamma) = 0$ has probability at most $(N-1)/(|\mathbb{F}| - M - 1)$. Fix γ with $D(\gamma) \neq 0$, and the prover's w_Q (a function of γ). If w_Q has no codeword within fibre distance δ , (γ, θ) is good for every θ by Lemma 17(1). If it decodes to $\hat{Q} = V_{\hat{a}}(\gamma X)$, then Lemma 17(3) would give $\sum_w \gamma^w \hat{c}(w) = V_{\hat{c}}(\gamma) = [X^{N-1}] V_{\hat{a}}(\gamma X) V_{\hat{b}}^* = \sum_w \gamma^w \hat{a}(w) \hat{b}(w)$, i.e. $D(\gamma) = 0$; so every θ is good. Otherwise $\hat{Q} - V_{\hat{a}}(\gamma X)$ is a nonzero polynomial of degree $\leq N-1$, fixed before θ is drawn; the event $\hat{Q}(\theta) = V_{\hat{a}}(\gamma \theta)$ has probability at most $(N-1)/(|\mathbb{F}| - 2M)$, and outside it Lemma 17(2) fails, so θ is good. $\square$

When $|\mathbb{F}| \gg M$ the first two terms are about $2N/|\mathbb{F}|$, so $\varepsilon_{\text{Had}} \approx (8M + 2N)/|\mathbb{F}| + \varepsilon_{\text{fold}} + (1 - \delta)^\kappa$, against $3M/|\mathbb{F}|$ for Π_{IP} and $2M/|\mathbb{F}|$ for an evaluation. The curve has degree 8 because w_a and w_c must be in the batch themselves: a quotient word alone determines w_a on T only as a polynomial of degree $\leq N$, which does not identify the decoding.

Knowledge and binding follow as for Π_{IP} (KF Cor. 7.12): the extractor decodes w_a, w_b, w_c at radius δ , and the decoded tables form the unique witness.

Remark 19 (Consequence). Linear functionals (evaluations, with the kernel E_z^*), inner products (Π_{IP}) and Hadamard checks (Π_{Had}) are all proved on table-form Kronecker-FRI commitments by one folding test each, with no sumcheck and a verifier that is an FRI verifier plus $O(1)$ operations per query point (plus $O(n)$ for E_z^*). For R1CS-type SNARKs what remains is the sparse matrix-vector products Az, Bz, Cz , which Spartan handles with its own sparse-polynomial commitment; whether those admit a coefficient-extraction form is the next question.

4 Relation to known techniques and status

Writing an inner product as the middle coefficient of a product with a reversed polynomial is classical, and appears in pairing-based multilinear commitments (Mercury [3] uses the table form with KZG). DEEP quotients for out-of-domain values are standard in FRI-based STARKs. The new points here are: (1) the reversed virtual word w_b^* , which reads the second vector from the *same* Reed-Solomon commitment thanks to $L^{-1} = L$; (2) the reuse of Kronecker-FRI's opening polynomial, virtual word and single folding test, with a fully proved soundness bound (Lemma 9); (3) the table-form evaluation kernel E_z^* , which gives evaluation openings on the same commitments; (4) a Hadamard check in which the out-of-domain values are DEEP quotient words inside the same batch as the opening polynomial, so that one degree-8 curve and one folding test carry the whole argument (Lemma 17).

Prover cost and the sumcheck baseline. The prover of Π_{IP} computes one product $V_a V_b^*$ of two polynomials of degree $< N$ over the base field (three NTTs of size $2N$), one NTT of size M and one Merkle tree for w_A , and then runs the folding test; every round-1 object lies in the base field, since V_a, V_b do. The natural baseline is the sumcheck route: n rounds of a degree-2 sumcheck on $\sum_w a(w)b(w)$, followed by openings of a and b at the random point. For that baseline the fastest prover we know of in our own work is the tree circuit of [4], which produces the evaluations, hypercube sums and sumcheck round polynomials of a multilinear polynomial from one binary-tree recursion; the comparison of the two routes at equal soundness is left to the implementation paper.

Status.

- *Lean 4.* Sections 1–2 are formalised in the Kronecker-FRI Lean project, files `TableForm.lean` and `InnerProduct.lean`, without `sorry` and with the single axiom of that project (correlated agreement for curves, KF Thm 2.16, here with $t = 3$). Lemma 2: `eval_table`; Lemma 3: `inner_product`; Lemma 4: `splitG_iff`, `natDegree_PhiG_le`, `identityG`; Lemma 5: `wrev_ev`, `wrev_eq_iff`, `inv_image_closed`, `ncard_inv_image`; completeness: `honestIP_prob_one`; Lemma 9: `batching_IP`; soundness: `soundness_IP`, and `soundnessC_IP` for any folding arity 2^k ; knowledge and binding: `knowledge_IP`, `binding_IP`. The common step of KF Lemma 7.4 and Lemma 9, correlated agreement on one fibre-closed set for a curve of any degree, is the separate theorem `curve_agreement`.
- *Rust.* The module `ip` of the Kronecker-FRI crate implements Π_{IP} with Merkle caps, arity 2^k and Fiat–Shamir, on the commitments of `pcs`. Its tests check Lemmas 3, 4 and 5(1), completeness for $n \leq 10$, two rates and arities 2 to 16, and the rejection of three cheating provers (a wrong S ; a wrong S absorbed into a polynomial A of degree N , as in KF Remark 4.13; opening polynomials computed from a table $b' \neq b$).
- *Section 3.* The proofs are written out above and not yet formalised; the Lean formalisation reuses `curve_agreement` ($t = 8$), `identityG` and the reversed words, and adds Lemma 13. The module `had` implements Π_{Had} on the shared folding-test code of module `ft`, drawing γ, θ by rejection sampling outside the base field $\mathbb{F}_p \supseteq L$ (a subset of the sets of Definition 14; the two first terms of ε_{Had} become $(N - 1)/(|\mathbb{F}| - p)$ each); its tests check completeness for $n \leq 10$, two rates and arities 2 to 16, and the rejection of a wrong y_1 , of a wrong Q (with $y_1 = Q(\theta)$), and of a false instance (c differing from $a \circ b$ in one entry) with three choices of y_3 . Removing $q[w_c, y_3, \gamma]$ from the batch makes the false instance accepted, and a wrong pole in the verifier breaks completeness, so the tests exercise each part.

n	prove (ms)			verify (ms)			proof (KiB)		
	KF	IP	Had	KF	IP	Had	KF	IP	Had
12	7.5	6.2	17.6	2.09	2.13	4.31	138.1	171.4	289.1
14	32.2	25.9	74.0	2.56	2.60	4.97	182.3	233.4	371.1
16	141.4	109.2	314.7	3.24	3.25	5.63	249.8	308.1	458.8
18	548.2	437.8	1353.6	3.87	4.01	6.40	325.0	395.3	565.7
20	2736.6	1947.4	6004.5	4.59	5.13	7.39	391.7	471.1	662.0

Table 1: KF: one evaluation opening (Π_{KF}); IP: one inner product (Π_{IP}); Had: one Hadamard check (Π_{Had}). Configuration KF-8 of the Kronecker-FRI paper (rate $1/4$, arity 8, caps of 128 nodes, $\ell = n - 8$), 148 queries, 32-byte salts, $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ over Goldilocks; one core of an Intel Xeon at 2.10 GHz; medians; commitments not included. Source: `bench/ip.csv`, `cargo run --release --example ip.bench`.

An inner product of two committed tables costs less prover time than one evaluation opening

(the round-1 work is in the base field), about the same verifier time, and about 20% more proof, the extra openings of w_b on the inverse cosets. A Hadamard check costs about 2.2 evaluation openings of prover time (its polynomials Q , A , H lie in the extension field) and 1.7 times the proof, since five oracles are opened per query instead of two; when a , b , c are committed together, one tree with three values per leaf removes two of the five authentication paths per query.

Next. Lean formalisation of Section 3; batching Π_{IP} , Π_{Had} and evaluation openings (KF Thm 11.2) in one folding test; the sparse products Az, Bz, Cz .

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